January 20, in the White House. The formal inaugural ceremonies and parade were scheduled the following day. But on Sunday afternoon, the inaugural committee came to the White House and suggested I cancel the parade and outdoor ceremony because the wind-chill factor the next day was predicted to be twenty degrees below zero or worse; doctors were warning that at that temperature, exposed skin would freeze in about fifteen seconds. We couldn't inflict that on the bandsmen and other people who had come to Washington for the parade, so we canceled it, and just before noon the following day, George and I took our oaths of office a second time before about one thousand people in the Capitol rotunda.

Afterward, at the traditional inaugural lunch with congressmen, Tip O'Neill made a point of telling me privately that he was very much aware of the fact that we had received fifty-nine percent of the vote during the election. I hoped that was a signal he'd be more agreeable the second time around, but it didn't work out that way. As far as he was concerned, it still wasn't six o'clock.

I felt sorry for all those bandsmen who had come to Washington from the fifty states and were deprived by cold weather of a chance to participate in the inaugural parade, so that afternoon Nancy and I helicoptered to a big arena in Maryland where thousands of disappointed paraders from all over the nation were gathered in their uniforms and regalia. I got a chance to thank them and they got a chance to play some of the music they'd planned for the parade. We all had fun, and I think it made up for some of their disappointment.

That night, there were eleven inaugural balls. Nancy and I got to all of them and danced a few steps at each.

The next day, January 22, it was back to work. On the economic front, my biggest goal for the second term was to make the federal tax code less complicated and less onerous on the Americans who were the real producers in